the Zhou Enlai style that defined New China's diplomatic behaviour since 1949. The strident expressions of Chinese nationalism by Chinese diplomats on social media might bring some changes. Menon says it may still be too early to draw definitive conclusions and, his own sense is that the rise of chauvinism will be tempered by the renewed emphasis on China's past, which will ensure considerable continuity in the methods of negotiation that China is likely to practise in the years ahead. How this will pan out should remain a matter of high priority and a subject of deep study for India.

The Chinese Players

From the founding of the People's Republic of China, Mao underscored the importance of the Party's leadership over foreign policy, and it remains the defining characteristic of Chinese diplomacy. Diplomats in China, unlike their counterparts in democracies, have to be both 'Red' and professional. Since the ascendancy of Xi Jinping after the 18th Party Congress in 2012, the Party's control over the conduct of foreign policy has strengthened greatly. A senior academic from the Chinese Foreign Affairs University has described the ideal Chinese diplomat as not only virtuous but, more importantly, as having a correct political direction and position (*zhengque de zhengzhi lichang he zhengzhi fangxiang*). The selection of high-ranking diplomats is done by the Communist Party's Organization Department in conjunction with the Ministry of Foreign Affairs. The Party Committee inside the Foreign Ministry and inside each embassy and consulate ensures that Party policy is implemented throughout China's foreign affairs system. [13] In a Work Conference on foreign affairs in 2014, President Xi Jinping laid out an overarching plan for the conduct of China's external relations, which has since evolved